

are still many firms that rely on EDI and are unwilling to change their technology platform.

8.3.11 ERP

Enterprise Resource Planning. A large and complex software system that integrates all the various departments of an organisation under a single software solution. Given the name, the primary task of the enterprise system is to optimise the use of resources and to provide the organisation's management team with analytical information that would be helpful in the making of decisions and in the daily operations of the company. There are multiple ERP software systems in the market, catering to wide variety of industries.

8.3.12 Intranet

Internal networks in organisations that use Internet-related technologies, which normally would not be available on the public Internet.

8.3.13 Mail Server

Server software used to send, receive, and store the e-mail of all users who have mail IDs in the organisation. Typically, depending on the actual size of the organization, the mail server software could either reside on a server or run off a normal PC. There are many different kinds of mail server software. Commercial options include Microsoft Exchange and Lotus Notes. On Linux there are a number of free mail server software available. Your choice would depend on the complexity of requirements. Consider whether the company's e-mail needs to be administered centrally or whether each individual user will manage his own mailbox.

8.3.14 Mainframe

This is older technology from the mid-1960s that refuses to die out! In the '60s, before the advent of the PC, access to computers was expensive. As a matter of course, many users would connect to a single server-grade mainframe machine. Mainframes were built for reliability and stability, and as compared to standard PCs and serv-